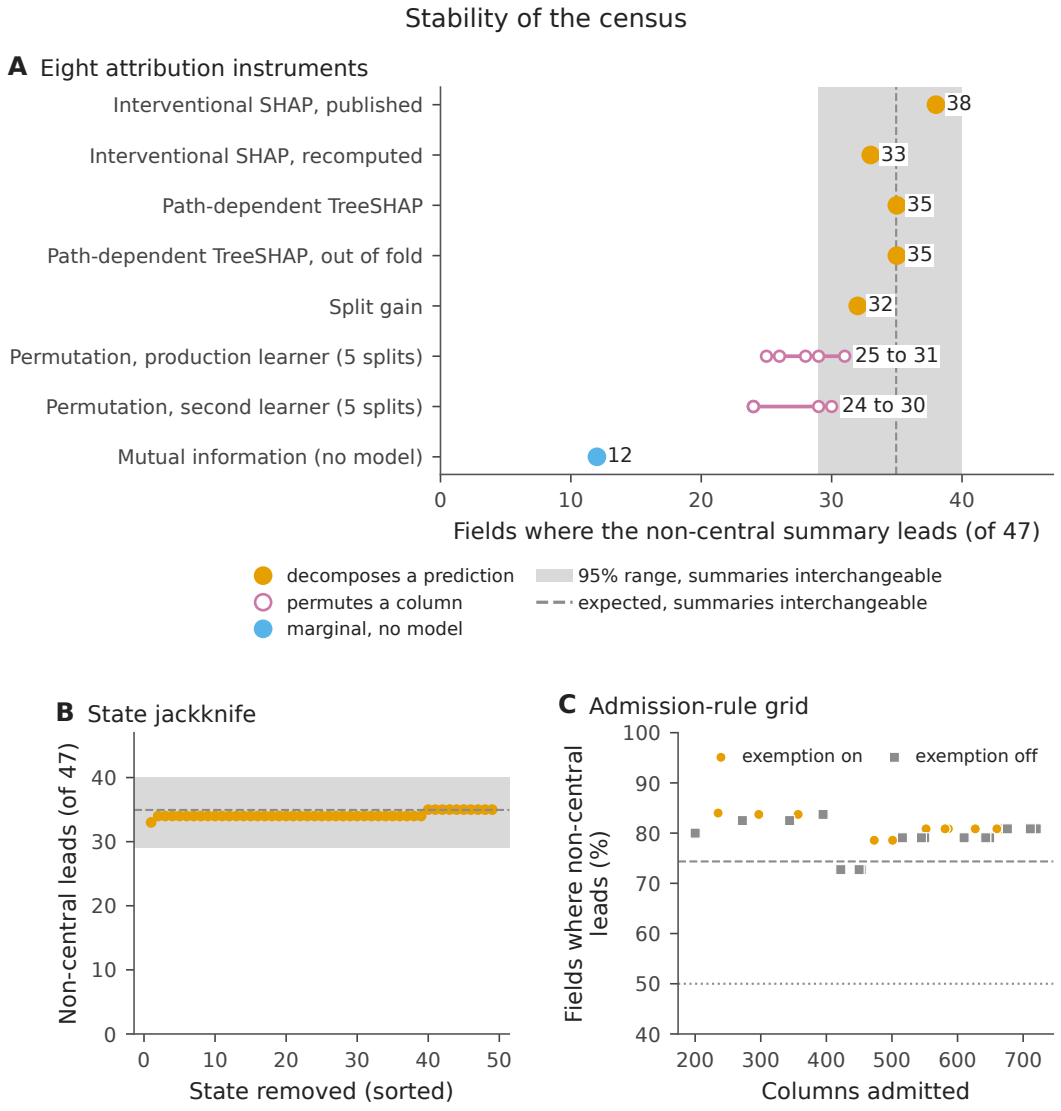Stability of the census